

WORD OF GOD

The **Word of God** is God's revelation to man. For every problem today, the Bible holds the solution. This is the guidebook to everlasting life.

I. THE BIBLE

- A. The Scriptures (Mark 12:10; John 2:22; Luke 24:27; John 5:39; 2 Tim. 3:15-17)
The Scriptures means Holy Writings.
- B. The Word of God (Mark 7:13; Rom. 10:17; Matt 4:4; Heb. 4:12; Col. 3:16)

II. THE COMPOSITION OF THE BIBLE

Old Testament:	39 Books (Genesis – Malachi)
New Testament:	27 Books (Matthew – Revelation)
Total:	66 Books

III. THE INSPIRATION OF THE SCRIPTURES

A. The Bible is the inspired revelation of God.

- 2 Timothy 3:16-17
- 2 Peter 1:21
- John 14:26
- Galatians 1:11-12
- 2 Peter 3:15-16

B. There are proofs that the Bible is the inspired revelation of God:

1. Its wonderful unity.

Over forty different writers wrote the 66 books of the Bible during a period of over 1,600 years, yet there is wonderful unity and harmony over the Bible.

2. Its versatility.

It meets the needs of all people of whatever race, nationality, language, custom or background. (Matthew 4:4)

3. Its superiority to other books.

The Bible is not *a* book but *the* book. It transforms lives.

4. Its influence on individuals and nations.

It has the ability to change the direction of lives and entire nations. It gives hope. It completes broken lives.

5. **Its preservation from century to century until now.**

It has stood the test of time and triumphed over countless critics, detractors and oppositions.

6. **Its fulfilled prophecies. (Isaiah 7:14) (Micah 5:2) (2 Tim. 4:1-3).**

Its accurate prophecies have always had the knack of being accurately fulfilled – not just marginally or generally, but in detail – so much so, that it can be followed by any human eye, from cover to cover.

7. **Its perfection (Psalm 19:7) (Jas. 4:1-3)**

Fallible man in the hand of infallible God created what is both inerrant and infallible.

IV. THE PURPOSE AND MESSAGE OF THE SCRIPTURES

A. **To reveal God to man.**

- Genesis 1:1
- Job 11:7; 37:23-24
- Ecclesiastes 3:11; 8:17
- Isaiah 40:28
- Romans 11:33-34
- 1Corinthians 2:16

B. **To show man his need of God.**

- Man's ignorance of his need (John 1:10; 4:10; 9:41)
- The way to God is revealed (John 14:6; Acts 4:12; 16:30)

V. POINTS TO REMEMBER IN READING THE BIBLE

A. **Read it lovingly.**

The Bible is the Word of my Savior to me.

B. **Read it reverently.**

The Bible is the Word of my Almighty God.

C. **Read it prayerfully.**

The Bible is God's message to me.

D. **Read it meditatively.**

Be like Joshua and meditate on the Word of God. (Joshua 1:8)

E. **Read it systematically.**